

Dicevania

Quintet of Rolls

Dicevania - Side A

1477, Transylvania. After the death of Vlad III, Bran Castle slowly fell into disuse. Some time later, the locals could not help but notice the eerie flashes of lightning that crackled in the castle at night, even when the sky was clear. They could not know that the Nameless Warlock, for inscrutable reasons, was repopulating the castle with monsters and traps, to welcome its rightful owner back from the dead.

Many years passed, during which the commoners learned to fear the horrors that sneaked around the castle, sometimes showing themselves at a window. One day, as many witnesses assured, some of those devils kidnapped the Hungarian Countess girl Anna, taking her to the castle's highest and most inaccessible room.

1558. Three heroes rushed to Transylvania, some in response to the pleas of Anna's mother, the noble Catharina, some for other reasons. They're ready to infiltrate Bran Castle to rescue the child.



Kain, the monster hunter. From England, on the orders of Queen Elizabeth I, Kain was sent to Transylvania to rescue little Anna and establish a friendship between his family and the Tudors. Armed with his Silver Claw sword and with his knowledge of druidic magic, Kain vowed that he would return with the maiden.

Zero, the Occultist. Informed by Charles V of Habsburg, who had now retired to the monastery of Yuste, Zero decided to leave Italy at his friend's request. The former emperor was very fond of Anna's mother, so much so that he believed she might be more than just a friend.

Nina, the Alchemist. As Ivan IV's Russia invaded the lands of the Livonian Confederation, Nina fled Reval to regroup and find a way to save her city. Accustomed to making do, she followed the trail of a strong magical energy that led her to Bran Castle. Perhaps, there she would find a power there that could turn the tide of war.

Dicevania - Side B

The Nameless Warlock. You actually do have a name, Abstractus, but it's best not to let people know. No one would believe what you saw, much less have the means to understand the reasons for your actions. The vision sent to you is true. Anna Bathory, the child Countess, will be the mother of a bloodthirsty woman who'll make a pact with the devil to bring death and despair to her lands.



Your pact with the devil, on the other hand, has always been a civil and respectful academic partnership. All the creatures you are summoning to Bran Castle will frighten the commoners, keeping the meddlers away for their own safety. You have managed to bring back from the dead as a vampire your good old friend Vlad III of Wallachia, unjustly remembered as "the Impaler," or "Dracula." Only his wisdom and iron fist will be able to keep the monstrous servants you are placing in Bran's castle at bay. Vlad will personally act as guardian and mentor to the child Countess Anna, instructing her in the arts and sciences, warning her against bearing children, for a cruel fate would be unleashed should she decide, when she grows up, to break the vow of chastity she must necessarily take.

Of course, Vlad can't wait for the little one to grow up so he can return to his research in the occult sciences. For now, you're arranging the rooms in the castle nicely so that they can contain the magical energy without collapsing the walls. As soon as you're finished, you'll leave. It makes you feel good to practice so much philanthropy, but you also have your own commitments.

Word has reached you that three reckless villains would like to "rescue" Countess Anna from Bran Castle. Hopefully, good Vlad will quickly dissuade these nuisances before they do too much damage.

Dicevania : Side A

 Get 5d6 or 5 poker dice, and a wet erase marker.

 Choose one of three characters: Kain, Zero, or Nina. All start with 8 HP (full HP bar, in the upper left, next to the heart icon) and a variable number of items, to be marked with a dot on the item bars. For example, if Kain is chosen, you must fill two of the three knife boxes with a dot, and one each of tomes, mirrors and potions.

 When an item is used, a dot is erased. You cannot use an item if you have no dots on its bar, and you cannot store more than 3 of the same items at the same time.

 You'll begin exploring Dracula's castle from the entrance, the darker blue room showing the image of Kain. At the beginning of each turn, you can move to an adjacent room to which there is an opening, blackening the location you left with the marker. After you've declared which room you're going into, that room **must be cleared** before you can start a new turn and move into a new room. Depending on what the room contains, you have to do a different thing to clear it:

Poker combination [up to 5-of-a-kind]. Roll 5d6: you **clear the room** if the dice make the required combination or a better one (*in poker dice, a straight beats a full house*). You score the points of the combination you rolled (refer to the score line below the map): bar as many boxes on a single of the reward bars at the bottom left, from left to right; any excess points are lost. You earn each barred item: mark it by placing a dot on the respective item bar. Remember that you cannot have more than 3 items per type: those in excess are lost.

If you don't clear the room you can repeatedly perform one of these two actions until you beat the combination:

Reroll: lose 1 HP and reroll any number of dice holding the new result; update your HP in the hearts bar. If the room contains an **enemy symbol**, you lose 2 HP instead of just 1.

Use an item: erase a dot from its item bar.

 **Potion:** you can reroll without losing any HP.

 **Knife:** subtract 1 from a die (minimum 1).

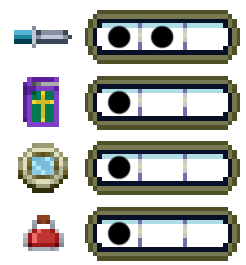
 **Tome:** add 1 to a die (maximum 6).

 **Mirror:** turn a die upside down (its new score becomes 7 minus the old score).

You **must** use as many actions as necessary, in any number and order, to beat the combination. Once beaten, you start a new turn moving to a new location.

Question mark [?]. Roll 5d6: if the dice score any poker combination (at least a Pair), you clear the room and you score the points of the combination you just rolled. You can freely take actions (rerolls and items) trying to get a Pair or to improve your dice to raise the score. Again, bar as many boxes on a single of the reward bars.

Red room. You just enter and blacken it. You must blacken every red room in the map to open the upper one, showing a door with a yellow cross [✚].



Orange room. You must use a key you previously found [🔑] to enter and blacken it. These rooms are obstacles to map exploration.

Items room. You collect every item in the room, marking a dot for each collected item, in the corresponding bar. Once you have entered such a room, you **must** collect all the items. If some items cannot be collected because you would exceed 3 units, then they are lost. Each treasure [💰] you collect allows you, as you choose, to check a box in a reward bar (first one or next to the last checked one, left to right), or to recover 1 HP.

 You can always move freely through the locations you have already cleared and blackened. The parts of the map that you already visited, rulewise, are considered a single explored location.

 The game ends when:

Defeat. Next reroll will bring you to zero or less HP. Bad news: the game is over because you die, but at least you can attempt the last reroll to increase your final score.

Victory. You enter the Countess' room (top center) past the Vampire, and save her.

Final Score. Count the blackened boxes on the reward bars, add up the remaining HP, add +10 if you saved the Countess, and add +10 if you explored every room and opened every door.

Dicevania : Side B

 Roll 5d6. Each result corresponds to one piece. Determine which pieces you rolled by placing the dice next to the corresponding outcomes. If you roll a piece with multiple variants (3, 5, or 6) you can choose any of them; if you roll two or more 3s, 5s, or 6s, you must pick at least one piece per variant. Once per game you can use and blacken the Warlock power (crossed-out die symbol), which allows you to ignore the result of a single die.

 You have to place all the rolled pieces on the map, in the preferred order. When a piece is placed on the map it must cover a red square and/or be in contact with another piece with at least the side of one square. Blacken the squares corresponding to the shape of the piece you're placing. Once all rolled pieces have been placed, repeat the 5d6 roll to determine the new group of pieces to be placed.

 When no more pieces can be framed, the game ends: your score is equal to 2x the orange squares covered by the pieces, minus the squares that were not covered.